STACKS, SHEAVES ON ALGEBRAIC STACKS: LEMMA-COHOMOLOGY-ON-SUBCATEGORY

THE STACKS PROJECT AUTHORS

Editorial note. Statement span is lines 4435-4460 of sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex; proof span is lines 4462-4618, the complete author proof (155 body lines).

Editorial note. Navigation stubs: 11 cited-but-not-included labels are supplied as non-load-bearing pointers with their pinned tags where the snapshot tag index has them.

Editorial note. extra_packages is empty on purpose: the retained preamble already loads xy with options and a second declaration clashes in the assembler wrapper.

Editorial note. Text is retained verbatim, including the author's own typos and placeholders.

Editorial note. Queue index 0 of queue_algebraic-stacks-sheaves.json (pb=6733, stmt 4435-4460, proof 4462-4618).

Editorial note. Cross-chapter same-label warning (NOT an occupancy conflict, Chief ruling 2026-10-13 evening): label 'lemma-cohomology-on-subcategory' also exists in stacks-snapshot-20261011 — a different proposition in a different chapter file.

Allowed standard prerequisites (editorial).

- Explicit prerequisite boundary. The cited inputs are prerequisites; the argument in the retained span is not replaced by any cited result.

Source reference. Original lemma 045C: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 045B: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma lemma-localizing: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 1194–1200. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma lemma-surjective-flat-locally-finite-presentation: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 3715–3727. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Date: stacks-project:stacks-sheaves.tex:local-snapshot-20261012; GNU FDL 1.2 or later.

Source reference. Original lemma section-cech: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 3093–3111. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 079Z: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 03F9: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 07A0: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 03AW: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 0791: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Source reference. Original lemma 00XR: sources/stacks-algebraic-stacks-sheaves/pinned-original-source.tex, source lines 4618–4618. Cited by the retained statement or proof but not part of the collected spans; supplied only as a navigation pointer. The argument does not depend on its content.

Lemma 0.1. *Let S be a scheme. Let $\mathcal{X}$ be an algebraic stack over S. Let $\tau = étale$ (resp. $\tau = fppf$). Let $\mathcal{X}' \subset \mathcal{X}$ be a full subcategory with the following properties*

1. *if $x \to x'$ is a morphism of $\mathcal{X}$ which lies over a smooth (resp. flat and locally finitely presented) morphism of schemes and $x' \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$, then $x \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$, and*
2. *there exists an object $x \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$ lying over a scheme U such that the associated 1-morphism $x : (Sch/U)_{fppf} \to \mathcal{X}$ is smooth and surjective.*

We get a site $\mathcal{X}'_\tau$ by declaring a covering of $\mathcal{X}'$ to be any family of morphisms $\{x_i \to x\}$ in $\mathcal{X}'$ which is a covering in $\mathcal{X}_\tau$. Then the inclusion functor $\mathcal{X}' \to \mathcal{X}_\tau$ is fully faithful, cocontinuous, and continuous, whence defines a morphism of topoi

$$g : Sh(\mathcal{X}'_\tau) \longrightarrow Sh(\mathcal{X}_\tau)$$

and $H^p(\mathcal{X}'_\tau, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) = H^p(\mathcal{X}_\tau, \mathcal{F})$ for all $p \geq 0$ and all $\mathcal{F} \in Ab(\mathcal{X}_\tau)$.

Proof. Note that assumption (1) implies that if $\{x_i \to x\}$ is a covering of $\mathcal{X}_\tau$ and $x \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$, then we have $x_i \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$. Hence we see that $\mathcal{X}' \to \mathcal{X}$ is continuous and cocontinuous as the coverings of objects of $\mathcal{X}'_\tau$ agree with their coverings seen as objects of $\mathcal{X}_\tau$. We obtain the morphism g and the functor g^{-1} is identified with the restriction functor, see Sites, Lemma 00XR.

In particular, if $\{x_i \to x\}$ is a covering in $\mathcal{X}'_\tau$, then for any abelian sheaf $\mathcal{F}$ on $\mathcal{X}$ then

$$\check{H}^p(\{x_i \to x\}, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) = \check{H}^p(\{x_i \to x\}, \mathcal{F})$$

Thus if $\mathcal{I}$ is an injective abelian sheaf on $\mathcal{X}_\tau$ then we see that the higher Čech cohomology groups are zero (Cohomology on Sites, Lemma 03AW). Hence $H^p(x, g^{-1}\mathcal{I}) = 0$ for all objects x of $\mathcal{X}'$ (Cohomology on Sites, Lemma 03F9). In other words injective abelian sheaves on $\mathcal{X}_\tau$ are right acyclic for the functor $H^0(x, g^{-1}-)$. It follows that $H^p(x, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) = H^p(x, \mathcal{F})$ for all $\mathcal{F} \in Ab(\mathcal{X})$ and all $x \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{X}')$.

Choose an object $x \in \mathcal{X}'$ lying over a scheme U as in assumption (2). In particular $\mathcal{X}/x \to \mathcal{X}$ is a morphism of algebraic stacks which representable by algebraic spaces, surjective, and smooth. (Note that $\mathcal{X}/x$ is equivalent to $(Sch/U)_{fppf}$, see Lemma lemma-localizing.) The map of sheaves

$$h_x \longrightarrow *$$

in $Sh(\mathcal{X}_\tau)$ is surjective. Namely, for any object x' of $\mathcal{X}$ there exists a τ-covering $\{x'_i \to x'\}$ such that there exist morphisms $x'_i \to x$, see Lemma lemma-surjective-flat-locally-finite-presentation. Since g is exact, the map of sheaves

$$g^{-1}h_x \longrightarrow * = g^{-1}*$$

in $Sh(\mathcal{X}'_\tau)$ is surjective also. Let $h_{x,n}$ be the $(n+1)$-fold product $h_x \times \ldots \times h_x$. Then we have spectral sequences

$$E_1^{p,q} = H^q(h_{x,p}, \mathcal{F}) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(\mathcal{X}_\tau, \mathcal{F}) \tag{0.1.1}$$

and

$$E_1^{p,q} = H^q(g^{-1}h_{x,p}, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(\mathcal{X}'_\tau, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) \tag{0.1.2}$$

see Cohomology on Sites, Lemma 079Z.

Case I: $\mathcal{X}$ has a final object x which is also an object of $\mathcal{X}'$. This case follows immediately from the discussion in the second paragraph above.

Case II: $\mathcal{X}$ is representable by an algebraic space F. In this case the sheaves $h_{x,n}$ are representable by an object x_n in $\mathcal{X}$. (Namely, if $\mathcal{S}_F = \mathcal{X}$ and $x : U \to F$ is the given object, then $h_{x,n}$ is representable by the object $U \times_F \ldots \times_F U \to F$ of $\mathcal{S}_F$.) It follows that $H^q(h_{x,p}, \mathcal{F}) = H^q(x_p, \mathcal{F})$. The morphisms $x_n \to x$ lie over smooth morphisms of schemes, hence $x_n \in \mathcal{X}'$ for all n. Hence $H^q(g^{-1}h_{x,p}, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}) = H^q(x_p, g^{-1}\mathcal{F})$. Thus in the two spectral sequences (0.1.1) and (0.1.2) above the $E_1^{p,q}$ terms agree by the discussion in the second paragraph. The lemma follows in Case II as well.

Case III: $\mathcal{X}$ is an algebraic stack. We claim that in this case the cohomology groups $H^q(h_{x,p}, \mathcal{F})$ and $H^q(g^{-1}h_{x,n}, g^{-1}\mathcal{F})$ agree by Case II above. Once we have proved this the result will follow as before.

Namely, consider the category $\mathcal{X}/h_{x,n}$, see Sites, Lemma 0791. Since $h_{x,n}$ is the $(n+1)$-fold product of h_x an object of this category is an $(n+2)$-tuple $(y, s_0, \ldots, s_n)$ where y is an object of $\mathcal{X}$ and each $s_i : y \to x$ is a morphism of $\mathcal{X}$. This is a category over $(Sch/S)_{fppf}$. There is an equivalence

$$\mathcal{X}/h_{x,n} \longrightarrow (Sch/U)_{fppf} \times_{\mathcal{X}} \ldots \times_{\mathcal{X}} (Sch/U)_{fppf} =: \mathcal{U}_n$$

over $(Sch/S)_{fppf}$. Namely, if $x : (Sch/U)_{fppf} \to \mathcal{X}$ also denotes the 1-morphism associated with x and $p : \mathcal{X} \to (Sch/S)_{fppf}$ the structure functor, then we can think of $(y, s_0, \ldots, s_n)$ as $(y, f_0, \ldots, f_n, \alpha_0, \ldots, \alpha_n)$ where y is an object of $\mathcal{X}$, $f_i : p(y) \to p(x)$ is a morphism of schemes, and $\alpha_i : y \to x(f_i)$ an isomorphism. The category of $2n+3$-tuples $(y, f_0, \ldots, f_n, \alpha_0, \ldots, \alpha_n)$ is an incarnation of the $(n+1)$-fold fibred product $\mathcal{U}_n$ of algebraic stacks displayed above, as we discussed in Section section-cech. By Cohomology on Sites, Lemma 07A0 we have

$$H^p(\mathcal{U}_n, \mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{U}_n}) = H^p(\mathcal{X}/h_{x,n}, \mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{X}/h_{x,n}}) = H^p(h_{x,n}, \mathcal{F}).$$

Finally, we discuss the "primed" analogue of this. Namely, $\mathcal{X}'/h_{x,n}$ corresponds, via the equivalence above to the full subcategory $\mathcal{U}'_n \subset \mathcal{U}_n$ consisting of those tuples $(y, f_0, \ldots, f_n, \alpha_0, \ldots, \alpha_n)$ with $y \in \mathcal{X}'$. Hence certainly property (1) of the statement of the lemma holds for the inclusion $\mathcal{U}'_n \subset \mathcal{U}_n$. To see property (2) choose an object $\xi = (y, s_0, \ldots, s_n)$ which lies over a scheme W such that $(Sch/W)_{fppf} \to \mathcal{U}_n$ is smooth and surjective (this is possible as $\mathcal{U}_n$ is an algebraic stack). Then $(Sch/W)_{fppf} \to \mathcal{U}_n \to (Sch/U)_{fppf}$ is smooth as a composition of base changes of the morphism $x : (Sch/U)_{fppf} \to \mathcal{X}$, see Algebraic Stacks, Lemmas 045C and 045B. Thus axiom (1) for $\mathcal{X}$ implies that y is an object of $\mathcal{X}'$ whence ξ is an object of $\mathcal{U}'_n$. Using again

$$H^p(\mathcal{U}'_n, \mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{U}'_n}) = H^p(\mathcal{X}'/h_{x,n}, \mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{X}'/h_{x,n}}) = H^p(g^{-1}h_{x,n}, g^{-1}\mathcal{F}).$$

we now can use Case II for $\mathcal{U}'_n \subset \mathcal{U}_n$ to conclude. □